



A FOUNDER'S PLAYBOOK

AI Wrote The Code. The Hard Part Was Everything Else.

What it actually took to build and launch a real AI product — the honest version, not the highlight reel.

SWIPE →



What 300 hours actually looks like

300

HOURS · 6 WEEKS · OUTSIDE MY DAY JOB

- Nearly a third of all code changes landed between 10pm and 5am
- Fitted around a full-time job and family — not a sabbatical
- 4 days from the first commit to a live site taking real payments



THE BUILD, BY THE NUMBERS

Not a weekend project

~15,000

lines of production
code, across 128 files

185

commits across
20 working branches

8+

production releases —
each one code-reviewed

13

SEO blog posts,
written and shipped

Every line reviewed and directed by a human — not autopilot.



QUALITY, TESTED HONESTLY

I built my harshest critics before my next feature

AI agents role-played skeptical parents — different ages, different mindsets — browsing the live site in character, deciding honestly whether they'd pay.

6

ROUNDS OF
TESTING

19

IN-CHARACTER
PARENT SESSIONS

0/3

WOULD HAVE PAID —
ONE HARD ROUND

All three independently found the same flaw: the age “personalisation” was cosmetic, not structural. That's months of customer feedback, surfaced in an afternoon.



FOR THE TECH-CURIOUS

A fairness bug hiding in the code

THE BUG

Computer Science could never rank as a child's top subject — across 3,000 simulated charts, it won zero times. A scale bug, not a talent gap.

THE FIX

Z-score standardisation — compare each subject to its own typical range, not a raw total. Re-verified against a 6,000-chart simulation.

*Stack: Next.js · TypeScript · Supabase · Stripe · real
ephemeris-based astronomical calculation, not templates.*



Research first, not a blind leap

● **Competitive gap**

Every direct competitor missed at least one of 5 things: real calculation, child-specific content, global tone, modern UX, honest positioning.

● **Channel strategy**

Paid social is a poor fit for this category. Organic content, SEO and Pinterest lead instead — backed by real case data, not guesswork.

● **Platform risk**

Payment processors restrict this category, so every word on the site was framed around education and parenting — never fortune-telling.

**Realistic projection: \$300-\$2,000/month within
12-18 months of consistent content effort.**



Astrology has run in my family for years

“

I've practised astrology for years, as a passionate hobby that runs in my family. With my own two kids, I used it as one more lens for understanding their strengths and how to support them better.

I wanted to offer that same reflection to other parents — and build it as a genuine passive-income stream along the way.

It's a starting point for conversations about a child — not a prediction. The site says so plainly.



5 things I'd tell anyone building with AI

1

Give your AI a memory

No session remembers the last one — keep a running build log.

2

Set your constraints first

Ethical and legal lines, decided before a word of copy is written.

3

Build your harshest critic first

Adversarial testing before scaling, every time.

4

Pause, don't delete

Park what isn't ready behind a flag — come back when it's right.

5

The uncomfortable result is the useful one

Every hard finding made the product better.



THE REAL SHIFT

**AI doesn't replace
judgement.**

**It multiplies whatever
judgement you bring.**

- Breaking a messy idea into clean systems
- Arguing against your own assumptions
- Setting guardrails before you build
- Knowing what to ship, park, or fix



Read the full story

The full playbook — the tech-curious details, the product research, and every lesson learned — is in the article. Link in the comments below.

littlestargazer.com

See the product this whole story is about

*If you're building with AI — or deciding how to —
I'd love to compare notes. Connect below.*

#AI #Startups #ProductManagement #BuildInPublic